

Monday, 21 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

22° 14°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

22° 12°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

20° 12°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

18° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Labour are criticising the billionaire owner of Manchester United, saying he's lost the moral high ground after becoming a tax exile.

The businessman told the BBC he no longer has confidence in the UK due to high taxes and high immigration. He moved abroad last year.

POLITICS · UK

2

Tens of thousands of fridge freezers are stuck at docks across the UK, after a recycling firm collapsed last year.

Household collections of the appliances have been suspended, leaving a huge backlog. They're now waiting in limbo until a takeover of the firm is complete.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

3

Earl Spencer says he can see echoes of his sister Princess Diana's treatment by the press in the way Harry and Meghan are scrutinised.

He described the press's influence on their lives as 'cancerous'. Earl Spencer is speaking ahead of the publication of his new book about Diana.

ROYALS · UK

4

A justice minister says he's 'deeply concerned' after a convicted killer was temporarily released from prison and then absconded.

Gary Anderson was let out of Maghaberry Prison to attend his father's funeral, but he remains at large. Police are now searching for him.

CRIME · UK

5

Moscow's mayor says Ukraine has launched its largest attack on the city, firing hundreds of drones overnight.

He says 450 drones were shot down during the barrage, in which two people died. Ukraine has not yet commented on the claims.

CONFLICT · WORLD

What's coming up

1 **Strictly Come Dancing is back on our screens with a brand new hosting trio, as the celebrities find out their dance pairings.**

Emma Willis, Josh Widdicombe and Johannes Radebe have taken over from long-running presenters Tess Daly and Claudia Winkleman. The new series promises even more glitter and drama!

ON AIR – Are you excited for the new series of Strictly? Who are you backing to win the Glitterball trophy this year?
TV · TONIGHT

2 **Sharon Horgan is back with a new comedy called 'Youth', which explores sex and dating for the sandwich generation.**

The actress admits it's 'really weird watching yourself age on screen'. It sounds like a relatable and funny look at midlife romance.

ON AIR – Are you part of the 'sandwich generation'? What are your thoughts on dating later in life?
TV · COMING UP

3 **Bad news for Oasis fans hoping to see them at Glastonbury 2027 – organiser Emily Eavis has confirmed they won't be headlining.**

Despite the rock band being on tour that summer, it seems Worthy Farm isn't on their itinerary. A blow for those dreaming of a reunion set!

ON AIR – If Oasis aren't headlining, who would you love to see top the bill at Glastonbury in 2027?
MUSIC · FUTURE

4 **A noughties garage track has been named TikTok's UK song of the summer, proving some tunes never go out of style!**

Kyla's 2008 track 'Do You Mind' gained worldwide recognition in 2016 when Drake sampled it on his hit 'One Dance'. It's clearly still a massive favourite.

ON AIR – What's your favourite noughties garage track that you still love to hear today?
MUSIC · NOW

5 **Guitars belonging to The Smiths legend Johnny Marr have sold for almost four million pounds at auction.**

One of the instruments was used on the band's debut album and even appeared on the cover of Oasis's first single. A piece of music history!

ON AIR – If you could own a piece of music memorabilia, what would it be?
MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

1 **Liverpool have made a solid start to the season, with impressive defence sealing a hard-fought win at Bournemouth.**

Andoni Iraola's side are looking good at the back, but he'll be hoping for more from his attackers in upcoming games. A promising start for the Reds.

ON AIR – Are Liverpool looking like genuine title contenders this season, or do they still have work to do?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **JJ Spaun has won the PGA Championship, hitting a final round of 67 to take the title.**

He becomes the second American in three years to win the flagship event on the DP World Tour. A fantastic performance on the greens.

ON AIR – Did you manage to catch any of the PGA Championship action over the weekend? What was your highlight?
GOLF · WORLD

3 **England's incredible 39-match winning streak has been halted after a thrilling draw with Canada.**

The Red Roses were held to a 26-26 draw in the WXV Global Series, ending a run that stretched back to the 2022 World Cup final. Still, a fantastic achievement!

ON AIR – After such an incredible run, is this draw a minor blip or a sign of tougher challenges ahead for England?
RUGBY · UK

4 **Matty Ashton scored a hat-trick as Warrington Wolves ended Hull KR's reign as Super League champions.**

Warrington secured victory in the play-off eliminator, bringing an end to Hull Kingston Rovers' time at the top. What a performance from Ashton!

ON AIR – Who do you think will go all the way and lift the Super League trophy this season?
RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

5 **Great Britain are World Team Cup champions for the fifth time, with Alfie Hewett and Gordon Reid securing a brilliant victory over Japan.**

The pair clinched a 2-1 win in Florida, adding another title to their impressive collection. A fantastic achievement for British tennis.

ON AIR – What an achievement for Hewett and Reid! Who are your favourite British tennis stars?
TENNIS · WORLD

Quick hits

- 1 British researchers have discovered that listening to certain classical music can significantly improve focus during everyday tasks.**
It seems a little Vivaldi or Bach might be just the ticket for making household chores feel a bit more harmonious. Who knew washing up could be so refined?
- 2 A delightful trend of 'community book swaps' is flourishing in village halls and local cafes across the UK.**
People are setting up small, informal exchanges, sharing their favourite reads and discovering new authors. It's a lovely way to connect over stories!
- 3 Experts suggest that the simple act of 'doodling' during meetings can actually boost memory retention and problem-solving skills.**
So next time you're caught sketching during a conference, tell them you're merely optimising your cognitive function! It's science!
- 4 A new study reveals that spending just ten minutes a day 'people-watching' can enhance empathy and reduce feelings of isolation.**
Grabbing a cuppa and observing the world go by seems to be a surprisingly good tonic for the soul. Just remember to keep it subtle!
- 5 The charming pastime of 'collecting interesting pebbles' from British beaches and riverbeds is seeing a quiet resurgence.**
These natural treasures are being used for decorative purposes or simply as tactile reminders of happy outdoor adventures. A little bit of nature, brought indoors.
- 6 Scientists have found that the aroma of freshly baked bread can genuinely trigger feelings of happiness and well-being.**
It turns out the smell isn't just delicious; it's a direct route to a cheerier mood. Perhaps that's why bakeries always feel so inviting!
- 7 The humble 'picnic' is experiencing a revival, with families and friends rediscovering the joy of al fresco dining in local parks.**
Forget fancy restaurants, a blanket, some sandwiches, and good company are proving to be the perfect recipe for a delightful outing.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of chocolate will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?
- ANSWER:** SMELLING IT VERY INTENTLY, AS IF OUR NOSE CAN DETECT DELICIOUSNESS.

- Q** Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new film, especially if it's a big cinema release. What is it?
- ANSWER:** REARRANGING THE SOFA CUSHIONS INTO THE 'PERFECT' VIEWING POSITION.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular quirky shop' you've visited on holiday or even in your hometown just sticks in your mind because it was so unique or charming?
What's the most unusual or delightful shop you've ever stumbled upon, and what made it so memorable?
- We all have that 'one small, everyday sound' that, despite its simplicity, just instantly brings a sense of calm or comfort to your day, don't we?
What's that gentle, reassuring sound in your life that you find surprisingly soothing? Perhaps it's the purr of a cat or the gentle hum of a kettle.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the scientific term for the fear of long words is 'hippopotomonstrosesquippedaliophobia'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Great Wall of China is so enormous that it can be clearly seen from the Moon without any assistance.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of ferrets is delightfully called a 'business'.
- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named 'Methuselah', estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- Did you know that the inventor of the Pringles can is buried in one?
- The tiny country of San Marino is completely surrounded by Italy.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one-hundredth of a second.

On this day

Day 264 of the year, 101 days left in 2026. Today Autumnal equinox observances in the Northern Hemisphere, vernal equinox observances in the Southern Hemisphere (see September 22): Spring Day (Argentina); Christian feast day: Cadoc; Christian feast day: Ephigenia of Ethiopia; Christian feast day: Laurent-Joseph-Marius Imbert (one of the Korean Martyrs). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Rose Garrard, English sculptor and author
- 1968 — David Jude Jolicoeur, American rapper, songwriter, and producer (died 2023)
- 1940 — Ron Fenton, English footballer, coach, and manager (died 2013)
- 1983 — Maggie Grace, American actress
- 1979 — James Allan, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1969 — Billy Porter, American actor and singer
- 1981 — Sarah Whatmore, English singer-songwriter
- 1972 — Liam Gallagher, English singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1971 — Bahrain, Bhutan and Qatar join the United Nations.
- 2001 — Ross Parker is murdered in Peterborough, England, by a gang of ten British Pakistani youths.
- 1976 — Seychelles joins the United Nations.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1972 — Philippine president Ferdinand Marcos begins authoritarian rule by declaring martial law.
- 1981 — Sandra Day O'Connor is unanimously approved by the U.S. Senate as the first female Supreme Court justice.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2013 — Al-Shabaab Islamic militants attack the Westgate shopping mall in Kenya, killing at least 67 people.
- 1977 — Malév Flight 203 crashes near Urziceni, killing 29 people.
- 2019 — A 5.6 Mw earthquake shakes the Albanian port of Durrës. Forty-nine people are injured in the capital, Tirana.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 265 of the year, 100 days left in 2026. Today American Business Women's Day (United States); Baltic Unity Day (Lithuania, Latvia); Christian feast days: Digna and Emerita; Christian feast days: Emmeram of Regensburg. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — Bob Sapp, American wrestler, kickboxer, mixed martial artist, and actor
- 1944 — Brian Gibson, English director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2004)
- 1930 — Joni James, American singer (died 2022)
- 1982 — Katie Lowes, American actress
- 1969 — Matt Sharp, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1957 — Steve Carney, English footballer (died 2013)
- 1967 — Matt Besser, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1966 — Ruth Jones, Welsh actress, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1965 — The Indo-Pakistani War of 1965 between India and Pakistan over Kashmir ends after the United Nations calls for a ceasefire and after a last engagement near Dograi.
- 1914 — A German submarine sinks three British cruisers over a seventy-minute period, killing almost 1,500 sailors.
- 1953 — The Four Level Interchange, first stack interchange in the world opened in Los Angeles.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1995 — An E-3B AWACS crashes outside Elmendorf Air Force Base, Alaska after multiple bird strikes to two of the four engines soon after takeoff; all 24 on board are killed.
- 1914 — A German submarine sinks three British cruisers over a seventy-minute period, killing almost 1,500 sailors.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar